

FILM DOSSIER: WARLOCK

Phase 3 · Film #10 (Saga Film #27)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	27 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #10)
Phase	Phase 3
Real title	WARLOCK
Decoy / codename title	"GOLDEN HOUR"
Release date	Friday, March 8, 2019
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Denis Villeneuve
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 148 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + metaphysical cosmic fantasy

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	WILL POULTER , the only real actor to have played Adam Warlock. The Warlock franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Adam Warlock	Will Poulter	26
The Magus (<i>Warlock's evil future self</i>)	Will Poulter	26
Gamora (<i>her soul, in the Soul World</i>)	Zoe Saldaña	40
Pip the Troll	Danny DeVito (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	74
The Silver Surfer	Doug Jones / Laurence Fishburne	58 / 57
Thanos	Josh Brolin	51
Captain America / Iron Man / Thor (<i>final scene, 2023</i>)	Tyrese Avery / Marc-Anthony Bullock / Esther Smalley	37 / 37 / 36
Mistress Death	Aubrey Plaza	34
Stan Lee (<i>cameo, filmed in 2018: a soul in the Soul World who says "It's not so bad in here!"</i>)	Stan Lee (1922–2018)	—

A tribute card before the opening titles: "For Stan." Stan Lee died on November 12, 2018, and this is the first MCU film released after his death.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Jim Starlin's <i>Warlock</i> #9–15 (1975–76) and <i>Marvel Two-in-One Annual</i> #2 (1977): the Soul World inside the Soul Gem, Pip the Troll, Gamora, and Warlock's soul captured in his own Gem. <i>Silver Surfer</i> vol. 3 #45–50 (1990–91): Warlock, Gamora and Pip leave the Soul World to stop Thanos.
Supporting comics	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #2 (1991): Warlock takes charge of the fight against Thanos · <i>Strange Tales</i> #178–181 (1975, the Magus)
Nerf check	✅ The Magus is Warlock at the height of his power, turned evil. Warlock wins by accepting his own darkness, not by overpowering it.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	94%. It adapts the Soul World as Starlin wrote it and Warlock's 1990 return.

Straight from the page:

- **Inside the Soul Gem is the Soul World**, a **golden paradise** where the captured souls live in peace (*Warlock #11*; *MTIO Annual #2*).
- **Adam Warlock's soul** lives there after the Gem takes it (*MTIO Annual #2*).
- **Gamora's soul** is there too (*Warlock #15*).
- **Pip the Troll**, a cynical, rowdy, lovable troll, is Warlock's friend in the Soul World (*Strange Tales #179*).
- **Warlock, Gamora and Pip** leave the Soul World to fight Thanos (*Silver Surfer #45–50*; *IG #2*).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **The Magus is fought inside the Soul World** | MCU continuity. The Soul Gem took his soul in *Guardians of the Galaxy* (2014). |

| **The Surfer opens the way out** | On 616 the circumstances of their return were different. Here the Power Cosmic connects Earth to the Gem, which ties the Surfer into Warlock's return. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Adam Warlock	Cosmic energy manipulation ; flight; super strength; cosmic awareness ; regeneration by cocoon ; master of the Soul Gem's realm	All of it, including rebuilding a collapsing Soul World with his mind	Wielding the Gauntlet (<i>Avengers Forever</i>)	 100%
The Magus	Warlock's powers, amplified , with none of his mercy	Tears the Soul World apart	–	 100%
Gamora	The deadliest woman in the galaxy	She's a soul here, and she fights like it	–	 100%
Pip	Teleportation ; troll strength	Teleports the trio across the Soul World	–	 100%
The Silver Surfer	The Power Cosmic	Reaches into the Soul Gem's frequency from Earth	–	 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Trapped inside the Soul Gem on Thanos's hand, a golden god-man, a dead assassin and a foul-mouthed troll have five years to find the one crack in paradise that leads back to a broken universe.
Theme	Accepting yourself. Warlock has to face the Magus, the worst version of who he could be, to become who the universe needs.
Villain / antagonist	The Magus (main); Thanos (outside the Gem, beyond reach)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: PARADISE

- **The Soul World** is endless, golden and timeless. **Adam Warlock** has watched over its souls since Thanos took his Gem.
- **Gamora** arrives (from the *Infinity Gauntlet* post-credit scene). Then **Pip the Troll**, who has been in here for centuries and will not stop talking.
- Through the Gem, Warlock can **feel the snap**: half the universe, gone.
- He can also see **Thanos** through the Gem, sitting on his throne, with **Death** still not looking at him.

ACT TWO: THE MAGUS

- Something is **rotting paradise** from the inside: **the Magus**, whose soul the Gem took in *Guardians of the Galaxy*.
- The Magus wants to **take control of the Soul Gem from within** and use it through Thanos's Gauntlet.
- Warlock, Gamora and Pip are hunted across a Soul World that's falling apart.
- Gamora faces the memory of her father. Pip faces the souls he's wronged.
- Warlock faces **himself**.

ACT THREE: THE CRACK

- **Warlock vs. the Magus.** Warlock stops fighting him and **accepts him** as part of himself, and the Magus fades.
 - In **Earth time**, **five years** have passed. On Earth, the **Silver Surfer**, grief-stricken, **reaches through the Power Cosmic into the Soul Gem's frequency**.
 - There's a **crack** in the golden sky.
 - **Warlock, Gamora and Pip** step through it, **out of the Soul Gem and into the ruins of Earth, 2023**.
 - The Surfer is waiting, with **Captain America, Iron Man and Thor**, older and grieving.
 - **WARLOCK**: "I know how to beat him. You're not going to like it."
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	The Soul World is timeless. Its events line up with Earth time from Saturday, April 28, 2018 (the snap) to Monday, April 24, 2023 (the escape).
Where it's set	The Soul World (gold-tinted practical landscapes, filmed in Iceland and at the Wadi Rum desert) · the ruins of New York, 2023 (the final scene)
Relative to other films	It runs from the snap to the five-year mark. The last scene is the opening of <i>Avengers Forever</i>'s main story.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The Soul World, Pip, the Magus** (seemingly gone for good).
- **Warlock** comes back as the Infinity Saga's savior.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The five-year gap	Warlock steps out into 2023	<i>Avengers Forever</i>
The Magus's end	He fades	(616: he returns in <i>The Infinity War</i> , 1992, after the saga)

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Warlock's plan	"You're not going to like it."	Warlock knows that Thanos always leaves himself a way to lose.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "PIP." Pip sees New York in 2023 for the first time: <i>"Yeah, this is worse than the Soul World."</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "ASCENSION." Thanos's temple. Thanos , with Mephisto beside him, closes his eyes. His body goes still , and something enormous and luminous rises out of it into the stars. He's becoming the universe itself. MEPHISTO (to himself, smiling): <i>"Higher, Titan. Higher. The fall will be so much longer."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "ADAM WARLOCK WILL RETURN IN AVENGERS FOREVER."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "SIGHTSEEING." Post-credit: "ELEVATOR."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline